

Species	Traits	Firewood Suitability	Uses & Warnings		
English Oak (<i>Quercus robur</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Excellent • Seasoning: 2+ Years • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Steady heat, sweet aroma	• Crafts: Structural timber, flooring, barrels, shipbuilding. • Pests: Acute Oak Decline, Oak Processionary Moth. • Safety: Acorns toxic to livestock; tannins can corrode iron.		
Ash (<i>Fraxinus excelsior</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Excellent • Seasoning: 6-12 Months • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Minimal smoke, neutral heat	• Crafts: Tool handles, hockey sticks, oars, fine furniture. • Pests: Ash Dieback (Chalara). • Safety: None.		
Beech (<i>Fagus sylvatica</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: Medium	• Value: Excellent • Seasoning: 1-2 Years • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Steady, intense heat, crackles	• Crafts: Furniture, flooring, kitchen utensils, tool parts. • Pests: Beech Bark Disease, Phytophthora. • Safety: None.		
Silver Birch (<i>Betula pendula</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Good • Seasoning: 1 Year • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Bright flame, sweet birch scent	• Crafts: Bobbins, toys, turnery, plywood, kindling. • Pests: Birch Dieback, Birch Polypore. • Safety: Fine sawdust can irritate respiratory tract.		
Sycamore (<i>Acer pseudoplatanus</i>)	• Native: No • Wildlife Value: Medium	• Value: Good • Seasoning: 1 Year • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Clean burn, very mild smoke	• Crafts: Kitchenware (non-tainting), violins, veneers. • Pests: Sooty Bark Disease. • Safety: Seeds and seedlings highly toxic to horses.		
Scots Pine (<i>Pinus sylvestris</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Good • Seasoning: 1-1.5 Years • Spit Risk: High • Burn: Sweet resin scent.	• Crafts: Construction timber, telegraph poles, joinery. • Pests: Red Band Needle Blight. • Safety: High resin can trigger contact skin allergies; creosote risk in flues.		
Common Alder (<i>Alnus glutinosa</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Poor • Seasoning: 1 Year • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Warm, sweet scent; low heat	• Crafts: Canal lock gates, clogs, quality gunpowder charcoal. • Pests: Phytophthora Disease of Alder. • Safety: None.		
Hazel (<i>Corylus avellana</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Good • Seasoning: 6-12 Months • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Clean, steady, quiet burn	• Crafts: Basketry, hurdles, hedge-laying, walking sticks. • Pests: None major. • Safety: None.		
Sweet Chestnut (<i>Castanea sativa</i>)	• Native: No • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Good • Seasoning: 1.5-2 Years • Spit Risk: High • Burn: Sparks violently, sweet smoke	• Crafts: Fencing, roof shingles, exterior cladding. • Pests: Chestnut Blight, Ink Disease. • Safety: Tannins can stain hands and tools purple.		
Horse Chestnut (<i>Aesculus hippocastanum</i>)	• Native: No • Wildlife Value: Medium	• Value: Poor • Seasoning: 1 Year • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Smolders, low heat output	• Crafts: Woodcarving, cheap packaging crates, toys. • Pests: Bleeding Canker, Leaf Miner. • Safety: Conkers and foliage are highly toxic to dogs and horses.		
Hawthorn (<i>Crataegus monogyna</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Excellent • Seasoning: 1-2 Years • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Intense heat, pleasant smoke	• Crafts: Tool handles, mallets, wood engraving. • Pests: Fireblight. • Safety: Sharp thorns can cause deep, septic wounds.		
Rowan (<i>Sorbus aucuparia</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Good • Seasoning: 1 Year • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Clean, quiet burn, moderate heat	• Crafts: Woodcarving, tool handles, spinning wheels. • Pests: Fireblight, Silver Leaf. • Safety: Seeds and berries are toxic if eaten raw.		
Goat Willow (<i>Salix caprea</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Poor • Seasoning: 1 Year • Spit Risk: Medium • Burn: High moisture; spits heavily	• Crafts: High-quality charcoal, cricket bats, paper pulp. • Pests: Willow Scab, Rust. • Safety: None.		
Common Lime (<i>Tilia x europaea</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: Medium	• Value: Poor • Seasoning: 1 Year • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Low heat, neutral smoke	• Crafts: Intricate woodcarving, piano keys, beehives. • Pests: Aphid infestations (heavy honeydew drop). • Safety: Sticky sap can coat tools during felling.		
Field Maple (<i>Acer campestre</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Excellent • Seasoning: 1-2 Years • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Clean, very hot burn.	• Crafts: Harps, musical instruments, bowls, turnery. • Pests: Powdery Mildew. • Safety: None.		
Hornbeam (<i>Carpinus betulus</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: Medium	• Value: Excellent • Seasoning: 2 Years • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Intense, slow heat ("Kiln wood")	• Crafts: Windmill cogs, butcher blocks, heavy mallets. • Pests: Phytophthora. • Safety: Extremely tough on saw chains and carving tools.		
Wild Cherry (<i>Prunus avium</i>)	• Native: Yes • Wildlife Value: High	• Value: Good • Seasoning: 1 Year • Spit Risk: Low • Burn: Highly aromatic, sweet smoke	• Crafts: Fine furniture, decorative veneer, smoking meat. • Pests: Bacterial Canker. • Safety: Wilted leaves and stones contain cyanide; toxic to pets.		

Holly (Ilex aquifolium) - Native: Yes - Wildlife Value: High	- Very heavy, hard, and dense. - Uniform, bone-white colour. - Hard to split; cuts cleanly.	- Value: Excellent - Seasoning: 1.5-2 Years - Spit Risk: Low - Burn: Steady, intense heat.	- Crafts: Chess pieces, wood engraving, decorative inlay work. - Pests: Holly Leaf Miner. - Safety: Prickly foliage; berries are highly toxic to humans.	
Yew (Taxus baccata) - Native: Yes - Wildlife Value: High	- Heavy and dense. - Incredibly elastic and highly durable. - Tough and springy to work.	- Value: Excellent - Seasoning: 2 Years - Spit Risk: Low - Burn: Steady heat, pleasant	- Crafts: Traditional longbows, high-end turnery, tool handles. - Pests: Phytophthora Root Rot. - Safety: All parts (except red aril) are lethal if ingested.	
Wych Elm (Ulmus glabra) - Native: Yes - Wildlife Value: High	- Highly durable when wet. - Flexible but cross-grained. - Very hard to split (interlocking grain)	- Value: Good - Seasoning: 1.5-2 Years - Spit Risk: Low - Burn: Low flame, steady coal	- Crafts: Boat building, water pipes, coffin boards, furniture. - Pests: Dutch Elm Disease. - Safety: Wood dust is a known respiratory allergen.	
Sitka Spruce (Picea sitchensis) - Native: No - Wildlife Value: Low	- Soft and lightweight. - High strength-to-weight ratio. - Easy to split.	- Value: Poor - Seasoning: 1 Year - Spit Risk: Medium - Burn: Strong resin aroma; sparks	- Crafts: Construction joists, paper pulp, musical soundboards. - Pests: Spruce Bark Beetle (Ips typographus). - Safety: Fine sawdust can trigger asthma.	
European Larch (Larix decidua) - Native: No - Wildlife Value: Medium	- Highly resinous and dense. - Naturally rot-resistant outdoors. - Moderate splitting difficulty.	- Value: Good - Seasoning: 1-1.5 Years - Spit Risk: High - Burn: Sparks heavily; pleasant	- Crafts: Exterior cladding, fencing, boat planking. - Pests: Phytophthora ramorum, Larch Canker. - Safety: Sharp splinters easily fester under skin.	
Norway Spruce (Picea abies) - Native: No - Wildlife Value: Medium	- Soft, uniform, and pale. - Low natural outdoor durability. - Easy to split.	- Value: Poor - Seasoning: 1 Year - Spit Risk: Medium - Burn: Classic pine/Christmas	- Crafts: Cheap interior joinery, paper pulp, structural frames. - Pests: Spruce Bark Beetle (Ips typographus). - Safety: Resin can cause contact skin reactions.	
Douglas Fir (Pseudotsuga menziesii) - Native: No - Wildlife Value: Medium	- Strongest UK softwood. - Durable, heavy, and resinous. - Moderate splitting difficulty.	- Value: Good - Seasoning: 1-1.5 Years - Spit Risk: Medium - Burn: Sweet, citrusy-pine aroma	- Crafts: Heavy structural beams, cladding, poles. - Pests: Swiss Needle Cast. - Safety: Fine dust is a skin and lung irritant.	
Elder (Sambucus nigra) - Native: Yes - Wildlife Value: High	- Very soft with thick pith. - Mature wood is surprisingly hard. - Moderate splitting difficulty.	- Value: Poor - Seasoning: 1 Year - Spit Risk: High - Burn: Acrid smoke, unpleasant	- Crafts: Woodwind flutes, whistles, small carved toys. - Pests: None major. - Safety: Foliage, bark, and raw berries are toxic.	
Blackthorn (Prunus spinosa) - Native: Yes - Wildlife Value: High	- Extremely hard, heavy, and dense. - Rich dark brown wood. - Hard to split.	- Value: Excellent - Seasoning: 1-2 Years - Spit Risk: Low - Burn: Very high heat, minimal	- Crafts: Walking sticks (shillelaghs), turnery, small parts. - Pests: Silver Leaf Disease. - Safety: Sharp thorns carry septic bacteria that cause infections.	
Aspen (Populus tremula) - Native: Yes - Wildlife Value: High	- Soft and lightweight. - Low density, does not splinter. - Very easy to split.	- Value: Poor - Seasoning: 1 Year - Spit Risk: Low - Burn: Sweet smell but burns	- Crafts: Safety matches, sauna benches, paper pulp. - Pests: Aspen Rust. - Safety: None.	
Crack Willow (Salix fragilis) - Native: Yes - Wildlife Value: High	- Soft and lightweight. - Very high natural moisture content. - Easy to split.	- Value: Poor - Seasoning: 1 Year - Spit Risk: Medium - Burn: Low heat, high ash volume	- Crafts: Lower-grade cricket bats, pulp, charcoal. - Pests: Willow Scab, Anthracnose. - Safety: None.	
Corsican Pine (Pinus nigra) - Native: No - Wildlife Value: Medium	- Soft but highly resinous. - Moderate strength and density. - Easy to split.	- Value: Good - Seasoning: 1-1.5 Years - Spit Risk: High - Burn: Strong pine smell; creosote	- Crafts: Packaging, pallets, rough building framing. - Pests: Red Band Needle Blight. - Safety: Resin can trigger skin rashes.	
Crab Apple (Malus sylvestris) - Native: Yes - Wildlife Value: High	- Hard, dense, and tough. - Fine-grained wood. - Moderate splitting difficulty.	- Value: Excellent - Seasoning: 1.5-2 Years - Spit Risk: Low - Burn: Sweet, highly aromatic	- Crafts: Carving, mallet heads, luxury food smoking. - Pests: Apple Scab, Codling Moth. - Safety: Seeds contain cyanide (toxic if crushed).	